

CANDY DIALOGUE ENGINE

Background Scene Customization

1.1.0

Background scenes contain child nodes that are used for displaying "layer nodes". These layer nodes display backgrounds or background layers.

Background scenes are intended to be customized in the following ways by users:

- Size and position of the layer nodes on screen.
- Layer node types (TextureRect, Sprite2D/3D, etc).
- Name of layer nodes.
- Adding AnimationPlayer nodes to layer nodes.

Background scenes are meant to be swapped at runtime, as needed. The `$BG_Scene` command is used for that purpose. This allows you to easily switch background layouts for different parts of your game.

Nodes

Root

The root node can have any desired name.

Required Nodes

The following nodes are required:

Layer Container

- Can be any node type.
- Acts as a parent for layer nodes.
- Must not have any other children.
- Script pointer: `@export var bg_container`

Layer Nodes

- Display background layers.
- TextureRect, TextureButton, Sprite2D/3D, AnimatedSprite2D/3D or VideoStreamPlayer.
- Can have any name.
- The scene can feature any number of layer nodes.
- Must be direct children of the Layer Container.
- No script pointer.

Optional Nodes

Layer Animation Players

- Used for playing animations on a specific layer node.
- Must be AnimationPlayer.
- Can have any name. Must match a Background folder in the project resources (see below).
- Must be a direct child of the specific layer node it plays animations on.
- No script pointer.

Folders

Each layer node requires a folder in Candy_DE/Media/General/Backgrounds.

Each folder should contain image or video files that will be displayed as background layers by layer nodes.

Each folder must be named the same as the layer node(s) that will display the files inside the folder.

Layer nodes can only use files in the folder that shares their name. For example, layer nodes named "FG" can only access files in Candy_DE/Media/General/Backgrounds/FG.

The background scene that layer nodes are located in does not matter. Layer nodes can access the files in the folder that shares their name, no matter what background scene the layer nodes belong to.

Script

Base

The script **Backgrounds.gd** should be attached to the scene's root node.

Variables

Required:

default_image_extension

Indicates the extension to use by default for layer files, if no extension is provided with the file name, when the layer node is a TextureRect or TextureButton.

default_sprite_extension

Indicates the extension to use by default for layer files, if no extension is provided with the file name, when the layer node is a Sprite2D or Sprite3D.

default_animated_sprite_extension

Indicates the extension to use by default for layer files, if no extension is provided with the file name, when the layer node is an AnimatedSprite2D or AnimatedSprite3D.

default_video_extension

Indicates the extension to use by default for layer files, if no extension is provided with the file name, when the layer node is a VideoStreamPlayer.

sprite_fps

The FPS (frames per second) value to use when playing animated layers with Sprite2D/3D or AnimatedSprite2D/3D nodes.

bg_sizes

The size you want to display each Sprite2D/3D or AnimatedSprite2D/3D layer nodes at. These nodes can't be assigned a size directly, so must be scaled automatically through code.

bg_layer_data

Used by the code to store data about layers.

default_z

The default z_index value for the background scene. Should be lower than any other UI elements.

caller

The dialogue engine instance that is using the background scene.

Functions

All the functions in the script are required.

Editing these functions is not recommended unless you have a good reason to do so, and you know what you're doing.